

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1249

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to commend James "Mack" Hughes for eighty years of membership in the American Legion.

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that the members of this General Assembly should acknowledge and applaud those community leaders who have served their fellow citizens with integrity and devotion; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is James "Mack" Hughes of Greene County, a veteran of World War II and longtime member of the American Legion; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Hughes, who marked his 100th birthday on November 14, 2025, was recently recognized by the National American Legion Headquarters for eighty continuous years of membership with the veterans organization; and

WHEREAS, Mack Hughes graduated from Ottway High School in 1943 and thereafter joined the U.S. Army Air Corps; he attended pilot training in Dallas, Texas, and was transferred to Miami, Florida, for additional training and then to Albany, Georgia, to a B-25 bomber training facility; and

WHEREAS, he was part of a College Training Detachment at Presbyterian College in Clinton, South Carolina, and was still in training when he heard the news that Germany had surrendered and the war in Europe was over; and

WHEREAS, after two years of service in the U.S. Army Air Corps, Mr. Hughes was given the option to discharge and did so on November 8, 1945, returning home to Greeneville, where he met his future wife, Jewell; and

WHEREAS, Mack and Jewell Hughes secured jobs with the Federal Bureau of Investigation, traveling to Washington, D.C., where they were wed and began their service with

the Bureau; they were later transferred to the Bureau's field office in Charlotte, North Carolina; and

WHEREAS, while his wife remained with the FBI throughout her entire working career, Mack Hughes eventually departed the Bureau and accepted a job with the Motorola Company; following their retirements, Mr. and Mrs. Hughes returned to their hometown of Greeneville; and

WHEREAS, Mack and Jewell Hughes enjoyed sixty-eight years of marriage, until Mrs. Hughes's passing in 2016; the couple were blessed with a daughter, Cathy Hughes LaLonde, and two grandchildren, Kellie Neve and Jon Michael; and

WHEREAS, Mack Hughes epitomizes the spirit and commitment that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud Mr. Hughes for his military service and his dedication to his fellow citizens on this noteworthy occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we commend James "Mack" Hughes for eighty years of membership in the American Legion, extending our gratitude for his service to his country and the citizens of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.